

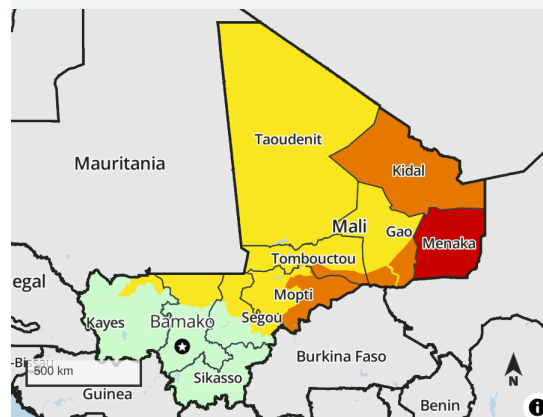
Reduced food access worsening acute food insecurity in the north and center

Key Messages

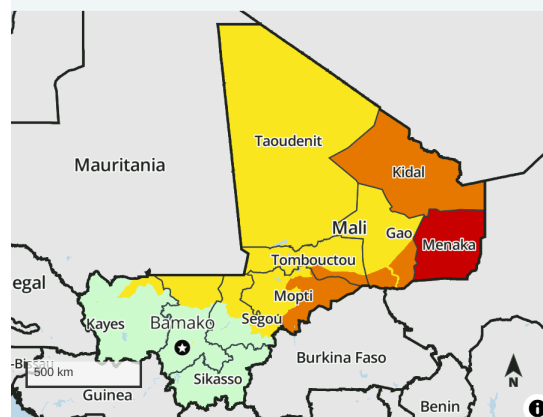
- **Emergency (IPC Phase 4) outcomes observed in the Ménaka region** will continue through September due to the severe difficulties populations face in accessing food, linked to the major deterioration of livelihoods and the high number of displaced persons. **Crisis (IPC Phase 3) outcomes will persist in Kidal through September 2026** due to degraded livelihoods. In other insecure areas, food insecurity outcomes ranging from Stressed (IPC Phase 2) to Crisis (IPC Phase 3) will continue through September 2026 for poor households whose purchasing power has been severely eroded.
- **The resurgence of security incidents in the north and center** between the army and armed groups continues to trigger displacement and further degrade household livelihoods. Coordinated attacks by Jama'at Nusrat al-Islam wal-Muslimin (JNIM) and the Azawad Liberation Front (FLA) on Mopti, Gao, Kidal, Kati, and Bamako on April 25, as well as the blockade of Bamako announced by JNIM on April 28, are disrupting trade flows. FEWS NET is monitoring the ongoing road blockages that are hindering trade flows and could affect acute food insecurity in Bamako if prolonged, and will update its analysis in May.
- **Disruptions to transhumance are causing an early deterioration in livestock conditions** in the northern part of the country, reducing livestock production and pastoral income, thereby weakening the purchasing power of pastoral households.
- **Disruptions in fuel supply, particularly diesel, are expected to continue** due to developments in the Middle East and insecurity along the Dakar and Abidjan corridors, leading to higher transportation costs and an increased cost of living. This situation limits poor households' access to food, forcing them to rely on borrowing, support from relatives and friends, and significant reductions in non-food and even food expenditures.

This report provides an update to the [February to September 2026 Food Security Outlook](#) and [March 2026 Key Message Update](#). The analysis is based on information available as of April 28, 2026.

Projected area-level acute food insecurity outcomes, April - May 2026



Projected area-level acute food insecurity outcomes, June - September 2026



IPC 3.1 acute food insecurity classification

Sub-national level data

- | | | |
|-------------|--------------|-----------|
| 1: Minimal | 3: Crisis | 5: Famine |
| 2: Stressed | 4: Emergency | |

Symbols

- ! Would likely be at least one phase worse without current or planned humanitarian food assistance

FEWS NET classification is IPC-compatible. IPC-compatible analysis follows key IPC protocols but does not necessarily reflect the consensus of national food security partners. For full disclosure, see endnotes.

Source: FEWS NET

Current anomalies in food security conditions as of April 2026

Security incidents continue to be reported across the country, particularly in the northern, western, and central regions, involving clashes between the army and the armed groups JNIM, FLA, and the Islamic State in the Greater Sahara (EIGS). Coordinated attacks by JNIM and FLA in the regions of Kidal, Gao, Mopti, and the cities of Kati and Bamako against military positions on **April 25, 2026** significantly disrupted population movements, especially in Kidal. On April 28, JNIM announced a **blockade** of Bamako, reducing commercial flows into the capital. Armed groups are **intensifying** repression against civilian populations. Restrictions on freedom of movement, combined with population displacement, are worsening already precarious household conditions.

Disruptions to transhumance movements caused by insecurity are leading to an early deterioration of livestock conditions in areas with high concentrations of herds in the north of the country, creating feed shortages for livestock. In addition to reducing herd sizes, these difficulties are causing animal production (milk, butter, cheese) to fall below typical levels. The decline in pastoral income is limiting the purchasing power of pastoral households.

Insecurity continues to restrict access to certain fishing areas in the Niger Delta and in Tombouctou and Gao, reducing catches and, consequently, incomes to below average levels, while also weakening the purchasing power of fishing households in these areas.

Market supply disruptions persist in insecure areas of the center and north due to attempted **blockades and the payment of illegal taxes** to armed groups, particularly in the regions of Ménaka, Kidal, Gao, and Tombouctou. Access to staple cereals in these areas remains limited for poor households because prices remain above the five-year average by 16 percent in Gao (millet), 25 percent in Ménaka (millet), and 37 percent in Kidal (wheat semolina) in March (Figure 1).

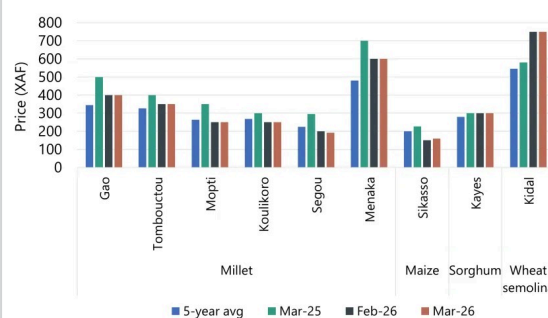
Persistent difficulties related to fuel availability have worsened due to disruptions in maritime trade linked to the conflict in the Middle East. At the end of March, the **government** increased gasoline prices by 13 percent and diesel prices by 30 percent amid an ongoing supply crisis within the country, and prices on parallel markets range from **double** to even higher than official rates. In **Kidal**, gasoline sells for 2,500 FCFA per liter and diesel for 1,500 FCFA per liter, compared with official prices of 875 and 940 FCFA, respectively. The country continues to suffer the impacts of trade disruptions related to the situation in the Middle East, given its heavy dependence on international fuel imports. Transport costs increased by more than **30 percent** compared with March, driving up the prices of essential goods (food and non-food), and further reducing the purchasing power of poor households in a context of declining income-earning opportunities. Following the increase in transport costs and the fees paid to armed groups in **Kidal** at the end of March, the price of imported rice increased from 40,000 to 65,000 FCFA per 50 kilogram bag.

The combination of the electricity crisis and increasing fuel prices continues to negatively affect the country's economy. Although fuel availability has improved compared with the previous three months due to the absence of attacks on fuel convoys since March, supplies remain limited outside Bamako. Rising production costs for industrial units and increasingly mechanized agricultural operations are **slowing economic activities**, further limiting employment and income-earning opportunities for poor households, particularly in urban centers and areas most affected by the fuel crisis.

Major disruptions to maritime trade in the Middle East, a major supplier of liquefied natural gas, have increased fertilizer costs on the global market. According to the agricultural service, fertilizer prices rose between February and March 2026 by 19 percent for urea, 18 percent for NPK, and 8 percent for DAP, reducing poor farmers' access to these inputs. At the end of March 2026, the country's available mineral fertilizer stock stood at 146,366

Figure 1

Price of staple cereals (millet, maize, sorghum, semolina), March 2026



Source: Food and Nutrition Security Monitoring and Early Warning Agency

metric tons, representing only 22 percent of the estimated needs of 676,646 metric tons. Reduced access to these essential inputs for rice, maize, and cotton cultivation during the typical supply period for the new agricultural season beginning in May is expected to negatively affect anticipated production. A government campaign, supported by technical partners, is underway to promote the use of locally produced organic fertilizers to mitigate impacts on agricultural production.

Humanitarian food assistance

Food assistance funding, amounting to 4.5 million USD since the beginning of 2026, has covered 3 percent of needs ([OCHA](#)); comparable levels had been observed in April 2025, but at that time covered only 1.8 percent ([OCHA](#)). During the first quarter of 2026, food assistance reached only about 9.7 percent (approximately 117,000 people) of the target population (1.2 million people), according to the [Food Security Cluster](#). This level is significantly lower than in a typical year before the contraction of humanitarian funding in 2025; around 491,000 beneficiaries had been recorded during the same period in [2024](#). Difficulties in mobilizing humanitarian funding have reduced the level of coverage of energy needs, with only **241 000** people planned to receive food rations covering between 50 and 100 percent of needs during the pastoral lean season from March to June 2026

Updates to key assumptions about atypical food security conditions through September 2026

Most of the assumptions that underpinned FEWS NET's analysis of the most likely scenario for the [Mali Food Security Outlook from February to September 2026](#) remain valid; however, the following updates have been made to incorporate new evidence:

- **Security incidents are expected to persist throughout the country, while evolving conflict dynamics will increase pressure on the capacities and efforts of Malian authorities to ensure security along major transport corridors.** Armed groups are expected to continue strategies aimed at multiplying tension hotspots across the country through attacks against armed forces positions, civilian populations, and increasingly against industrial facilities.
- **The increase in official gasoline and diesel prices will raise industrial and agricultural production costs, as well as transportation costs.** Although an improvement in fuel supply has been observed compared with previous months, the impact of the Middle East crisis will worsen the fuel crisis that has been ongoing in Mali since September 2025 through higher prices and reduced availability caused by maritime trade disruptions. Prices of staple cereals, which were generally stable at the end of March compared with February, are expected to rise following the fuel price increase at the beginning of April. Roadblocks established by armed groups on routes leading to Bamako will reduce trade flows and prolong disruptions in the capital. Disruptions in the country's fuel supply will persist, with the crisis particularly affecting diesel countrywide.
- **Tensions in international markets and rising transportation costs will further reduce imported fertilizer volumes and keep fertilizer prices high on the domestic market.** Mali's main [fertilizer suppliers](#) include Russia and Morocco, through Senegal and Côte d'Ivoire. According to the [FAO](#), the continuation of the crisis is expected to contribute to an average increase in global fertilizer prices of 15 to 20 percent during the first half of 2026, coinciding with the country's typical fertilizer procurement period (January to May). This increase is expected to result in further fertilizer price hikes in Mali (a net importer of these products) during the critical preparation phase for the 2026/27 agricultural season. Higher fertilizer prices will reduce import volumes.
- **Reduced access to fertilizers essential for food crops (rice, maize, millet, sorghum) and cash crops (cotton) is expected to lead to lower agricultural production** and fewer agricultural labor opportunities, thereby reducing rural household incomes in the context of atypically high food prices.
- According to the [April update of seasonal forecasts](#), cumulative rainfall is expected to be average to above average across the country, while **below-average rainfall is likely in southwestern Mali**. Reduced rainfall could negatively affect production prospects in this part of the country, although good spatiotemporal rainfall distribution may mitigate the impact of this deficit.

- **Economic activities, including off-season and rainy season agricultural activities from February to September, will be affected by supply difficulties as well as rising fuel and fertilizer prices.** Areas where agricultural mechanization is highly developed, such as the cotton-producing zones in the south of the country and irrigated areas in the Niger River Valley, will be particularly affected. Reduced production is expected, especially for crops with high fertilizer requirements such as rice, maize, and cotton.
- According to the [World Bank](#), **disruptions in national food production, rising food import costs, and higher hydrocarbon costs** are expected to fuel inflation in oil-importing countries. As a net importer, **Mali will likely experience these inflationary pressures.**

Projected acute food insecurity outcomes through September 2026

In northern Mali, Emergency (IPC Phase 4) outcomes in Ménaka and Crisis (IPC Phase 3) in Kidal will persist through September during the pastoral lean season. The resurgence of insecurity continues to disrupt the local economy and market supply chains. Household access to food is significantly reduced due to food prices that remain far above the five-year average in Kidal (37 percent) and Ménaka (25 percent). The sharp decline in pastoral income, particularly in Ménaka where herd sizes have been drastically reduced following excessive livestock sales and theft, is further worsening the situation. The ongoing early pastoral lean season will intensify the seasonal deterioration of food consumption due to atypically low availability of animal products and reductions in the volume and quality of meals. Poor households are unable to access food without resorting to negative coping strategies such as distress livestock sales, begging, and dependence on assistance. The already precarious nutritional situation in Kidal and concerning conditions in Ménaka (severe acute malnutrition prevalence of 3.4 percent according to the October 2025 ENSAN survey) will persist due to the atypical worsening of food consumption, challenges in accessing health and social services, and limited humanitarian assistance.

Despite similar security shocks, food security outcomes are more severe in Ménaka, where households have endured the prolonged effects of conflict, massive displacement (more than 20 percent of the population), and persistent inaccessibility of some areas. In Kidal, households still retain some assets due to the relatively recent intensification of attacks observed since last year. However, a **small proportion of displaced households and poor households in Kidal** — mainly displaced persons and poor households in inaccessible areas — **will face Emergency (IPC Phase 4) or worse outcomes.** Security incidents occurring since April 25 are not expected to significantly alter acute food insecurity outcomes in these regions at this stage. FEWS NET will continue to monitor the situation, particularly in Kidal.

In insecure areas of Gao, Mopti, and Tombouctou, particularly the districts along the border zone with Burkina Faso and Niger known as the “Liptako Gourma,” ongoing **Stressed (IPC Phase 2) outcomes will deteriorate to Crisis (IPC Phase 3) from May through September 2026.** The early depletion of food stocks will result in household market dependence for longer than normal, while incomes decline in the face of high food prices. Difficulties in accessing markets are exacerbating households’ reliance on strategies such as sharply reducing non-food and food expenditures, borrowing, and selling productive assets to meet food needs. Despite some income and food from agricultural activities, gathering, and animal products (milk, butter) in June, food consumption will further deteriorate through September due to reductions in the number, quantity, and quality of meals. The already concerning nutritional situation in these areas is expected to worsen beyond typical levels for the same period. **Poor displaced households and refugees in these zones,** who no longer have regular access to sharply reduced humanitarian assistance, will remain in **Crisis (IPC Phase 3) to Emergency (IPC Phase 4)** through September 2026. Monitoring of market functioning, obstacles to humanitarian assistance and economic activities at the start of the agricultural season, and population movements linked to recent developments will be strengthened to update the food security situation in these areas.

In the northern areas of the Ségou, Nara, and Nioro regions, ongoing Stressed (IPC Phase 2) outcomes are expected to continue through September 2026. A small proportion of the population, particularly displaced persons and the poorest households, will face Crisis (IPC Phase 3). Declining incomes linked to insecurity and the fuel crisis, worsened by the conflict in the Middle East, will reduce households’ ability to meet food and non-food

needs in a disrupted economic environment. The early lean season, caused by the premature depletion of food stocks and high food prices, will reduce food consumption compared with a typical year. Poor households will rely on reducing non-food expenditures, selling livestock, and increasing agricultural labor activities, reliance on solidarity networks, and borrowing.

In urban centers, ongoing Stressed (IPC Phase 2) outcomes will continue through September 2026 due to declining economic activity linked to the electricity crisis and the fuel crisis worsened by the conflict in the Middle East. Rising living costs are eroding household purchasing power and reducing access to food. Poor households are resorting to borrowing, support from relatives and friends, and major reductions in non-food and even food expenditures. In Bamako, the announced blockade could significantly reduce the flow of goods, including staple foods, from the rest of the country into the capital, creating a medium-term risk of price increases if disruptions to trade flows persist. This would further weaken the purchasing power of poor households whose incomes are already declining due to the economic slowdown. FEWS NET is monitoring developments and will update its analysis in May.

Although the **agricultural zones of the south are expected to remain in Minimal (IPC Phase 1) through September 2026**, declining purchasing power — resulting from reduced agricultural and non-agricultural incomes compared with a typical year — will limit adequate food access for a proportion of households. These households are expected to face Stressed (IPC Phase 2) conditions from June through September 2026.

Annex 1: Updates to events that would likely change projected acute food insecurity outcomes

*While FEWS NET's projections are considered the “most likely” scenario, there is always a **degree of uncertainty** in the assumptions that underpin the scenario. This means food security conditions and their impacts on acute food security may evolve differently than projected. FEWS NET issues monthly updates to its projections, but decision makers need advance information about this uncertainty and an explanation of why things may turn out differently than projected. As such, the final step in FEWS NET's scenario development process is to briefly identify key events that would result in a **credible alternative scenario** and significantly change the projected outcomes. FEWS NET only considers scenarios that have a reasonable chance of occurrence.*

National

A sharper increase in global oil and fertilizer prices linked to the conflict in the Middle East

Likely impact on acute food insecurity outcomes: In this scenario, extremely high global fertilizer and fuel prices are expected to lead to a sharper increase in the prices of these products in Mali, while also limiting their availability. Although a further official increase in fuel prices is unlikely under this alternative scenario, it is expected that reduced fuel supply linked to high global prices will result in a sharp rise in informal fuel prices, as well as a general deterioration in fuel availability countrywide. The simultaneous increase in production costs for industrial units and agricultural operations will slow economic activities, further limiting employment and income-earning opportunities for poor households, particularly in urban centers, who will resort to atypical coping strategies to meet their food and non-food needs. The limited availability and significant price increases will further restrict producers' access to fertilizers essential for food crops, thereby reducing off-season rice production more than normal, as well as the cultivated areas for the new agricultural campaign. Reduced off-season production and increased transport costs will drive up staple food prices, limiting poor households' access to food. Their purchasing power will decline from June to September 2026, during the agropastoral lean season, which will begin early (as soon as May) in insecure areas. As a result, an increase in the number of people facing Crisis (IPC Phase 3) or worse conditions — and even a deterioration from Stressed (IPC Phase 2) to Crisis (IPC Phase 3) — would likely occur in insecure areas that are highly dependent on markets for food consumption (Gao, Nara, Mopti, and Bandiagara).

Kidal Region

A military operation to retake Kidal occurs in May

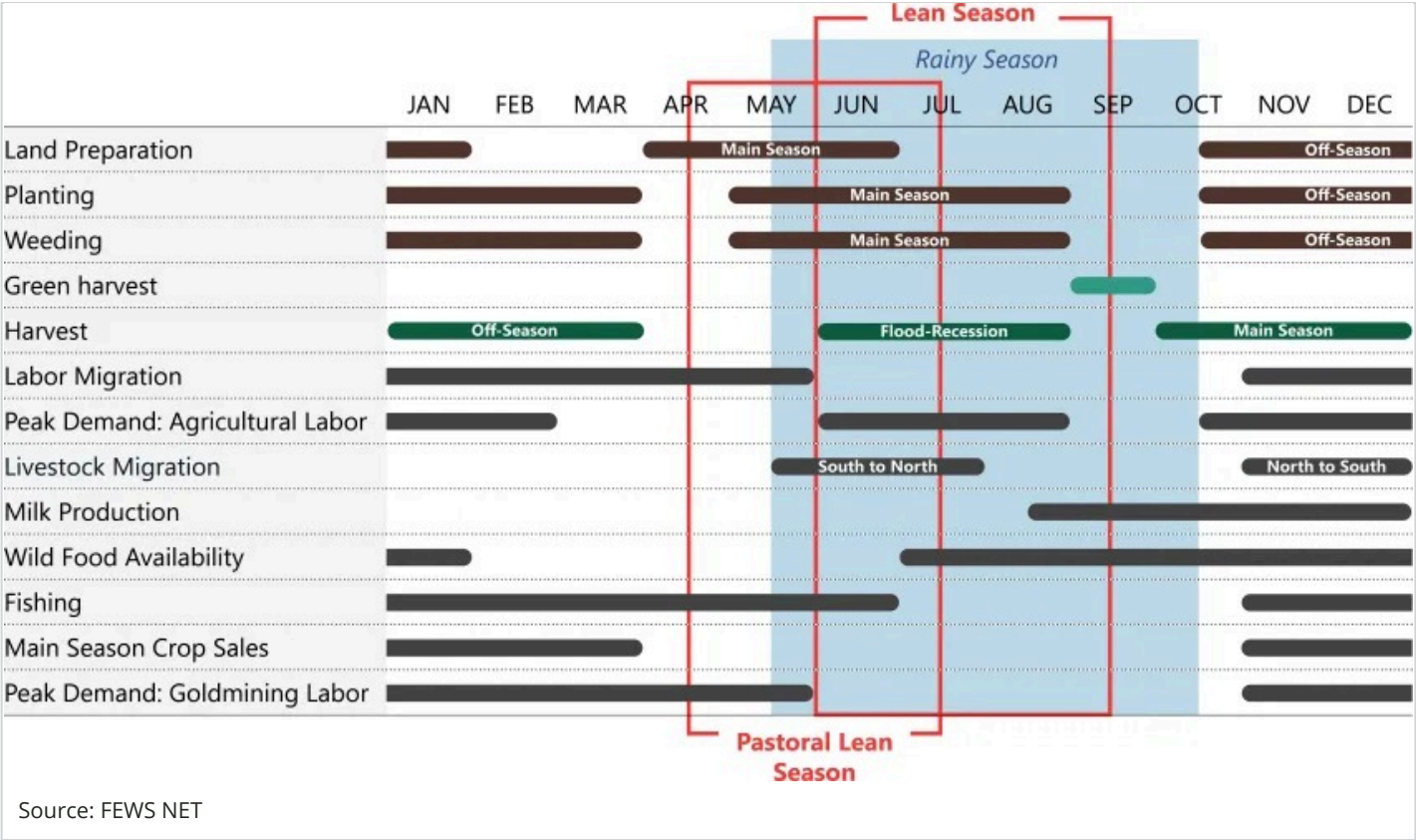
Likely impact on acute food insecurity outcomes: The army's decision to return to Kidal would trigger violent clashes with armed groups. Major disruptions to economic activities and market supply chains, as well as increasing food prices, would reduce households' ability to meet their food and non-food needs more than previously anticipated. Difficulties in accessing food and humanitarian assistance would increase the number of people in need. Under this scenario, outcomes in Kidal would deteriorate from Crisis (IPC Phase 3) to Emergency (IPC Phase 4) starting in May, in a region where economic opportunities are already extremely limited and populations are highly dependent on markets.

Annex 2: Updates to key sources of evidence used in this analysis

Many of the key sources of evidence utilized for FEWS NET's [February to September 2026 Food Security Outlook](#) remain the same; however, new and additional sources of evidence are listed below.

Evidence	Source	Data format	Food security element of analysis
Insecurity/conflict	Africom	Qualitative	Evolution of conflicts and intensity of security incidents
The energy sector and its associated products	INSTAT/Food Security Cluster , Mali Actu	Quantitative	Changes in fuel and transportation prices in Mali
Market supply in insecure areas	Food Security Cluster	Qualitative	Information on the impact of security incidents/blockades on trade flows and market supply
Agricultural inputs	FAO	Quantitative	Increase in fertilizer prices on the global market
Macroeconomy	World Bank	Qualitative	Rising inflation in oil-importing countries
Disruptions in oil flows linked to the Middle East crisis	ECOFIN	Qualitative	Impacts of the historic disruption of oil flows through the Strait of Hormuz

Annex 3: Seasonal calendar



Recommended citation: FEWS NET. Mali Food Security Outlook Update April - September 2026: Reduced food access worsening acute food insecurity in the north and center, 2026.

* FEWS NET classification is **IPC**-compatible with limited exceptions. IPC-compatible analysis follows key IPC protocols but does not necessarily reflect the consensus of national food security partners. As of IPC 3.0, the IPC no longer assesses the impact of food assistance on classification and thus no longer maps the (!). However, FEWS NET continues to produce food security maps inclusive of the (!) as well as maps compatible with IPC 3.0/3.1, which include the mapping of food security assistance bags. In rare cases, FEWS NET classification is IPC-aligned but not IPC-compatible. IPC-aligned analysis is evidence-based but some types of evidence required for IPC-compatibility were not available.

Food Security Outlook Update

This Food Security Outlook Update provides an analysis of current acute food insecurity conditions and any changes to FEWS NET's latest projection of acute food insecurity outcomes in the specified geography over the next six months. Learn more [here](#).